5.5 Craniotomy*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Drowsy after surgery **Objective** • GCS 13 • Head dressing • Pupils equal and reactive	**ACTUAL** Acute confusion related to post-operative cerebral edema as evidenced by reduced GCS and drowsiness.	• GCS stable or improving within 24 hours.	• Check GCS, pupils and limb power hourly at first. • Position as the surgeon orders. • Observe the drain output and the dressing. • Give the anticonvulsant and corticosteroid as prescribed.	• Met as GCS improves.
Subjective • “My head hurts.” **Objective** • Pain 6/10 • Frowning; reluctant to move	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to the surgical incision as evidenced by reported headache.	• Pain at or below 3/10 within an hour of analgesia.	• Give analgesia as prescribed and reassess. • Keep the room quiet and dim. • Offer a cold compress to the forehead if tolerated. • Report a sudden severe headache, which may signal hemorrhage.	• Achieved when pain is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Surgical wound • Drain in place	**RISK** Risk for surgical wound infection as evidenced by risk factors: open cranial surgery and drain.	• No infection and no CSF leak.	• Use aseptic technique for wound care. • Look for clear fluid from the wound or nose. • Watch temperature and neck stiffness.	• Outcome reached if the wound stays clean.

* **References for this care plan:** [7], [35], [37], [124], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.